



YOU ARE **7 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**

230 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The fronds that will form the early placenta can be clearly seen on the right here. At the bottom and separate from the embryo is the yolk sac, which is becoming ever smaller as its role is taken over by the placenta.

“ As your body begins to change shape, you may begin to worry about gaining too much weight. ”

Pregnancy is not a time to overeat; neither is it a time for fad or restrictive diets. By eating sensibly and exercising moderately, you should gain a healthy amount of weight.

How much weight you should gain depends on your starting weight. If you were underweight when you became pregnant, you should put on more weight than someone who is a higher weight. The starting weight is calculated by figuring out your BMI (see p.16), which is a measure of weight in relation to height. It's a useful tool to figure out approximately how much weight you should gain during your pregnancy.

If you are underweight (a BMI of less than 18.5), your expected weight gain is 28–40 lb (12.5–18 kg). If you are a healthy weight (a BMI of 18.5–24.9), your expected weight gain is 25–35 lb (11.5–16 kg). If you are overweight (a BMI of 25–30), your expected weight gain is 15–25 lb (7–11.5 kg). If you are obese (a BMI of over 30), your expected weight gain is 11–20 lb (5–9 kg). Expected weight gain will be more for a multiple pregnancy.

It is unsafe for pregnant overweight and obese women to diet, but not unsafe to manage weight gain through exercise and healthy eating.

HOW MUCH WEIGHT WILL YOU GAIN?

Every woman will gain weight at a different rate depending on her starting weight.

Try not to be too focused on weight and expect to gain a little in the first trimester, then more, maybe 1.5–2 lb (750 g–1 kg) a week in the second and third trimesters.

In the final weeks of pregnancy, it's normal to gain a few more pounds. Remember that the amount you gain will depend on many individual factors; and where you gain weight can also differ from woman to woman. Consult your doctor if you are concerned about weight gain. Also exercise regularly.